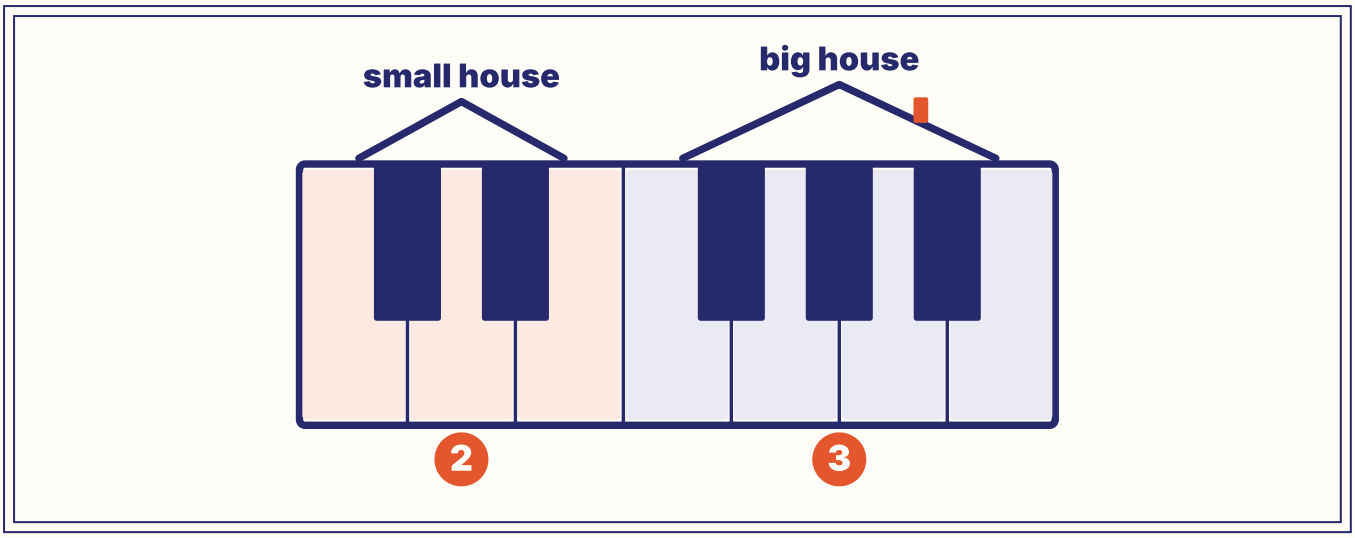
CHAPTER 2

Keyboard Patterns

The piano's 88 keys are one small pattern, repeated: a group of 2 black keys, then a group of 3. Know the pattern, and you always know where you are.



In this chapter

1 Small house, big house 2
2 The white keys of each house 3
3 The whole piano & middle C 4
4 Play on the patterns 5
5 Check-up 6

After this chapter, I can

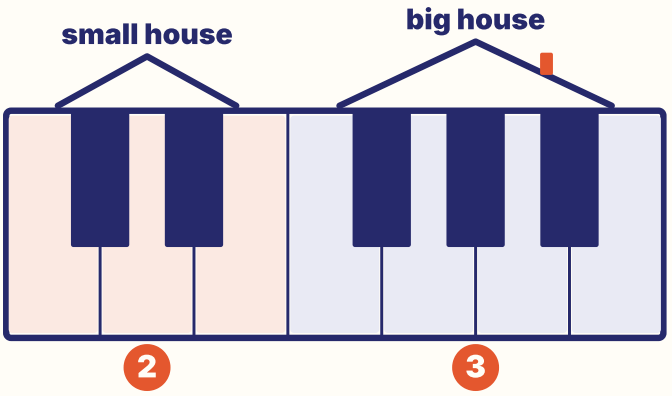
- ☐ find any small house or big house
- ☐ say which white keys belong to each house
- ☐ hear high and low on the piano
- ☐ find middle C on a real piano
- ☐ play legato on the black keys with 2 3 4

QUESTION How many groups of 2 black keys does a real piano have? answer on page 4

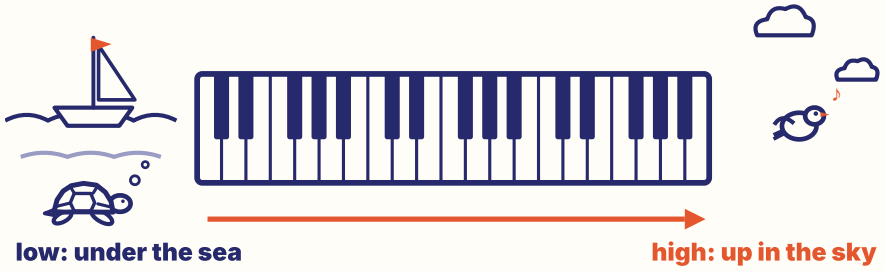
STEP 1

Small house, big house

The black keys come in groups. **Two** black keys make the small house; **three** make the big house. The two groups repeat all the way up the piano.



Left is **low**, right is **high**.



At the piano

1 Find a group of 2 and a group of 3 near the middle of the piano. ☐

2 From the bottom to the top, say each group out loud: “two... three... two...” ☐

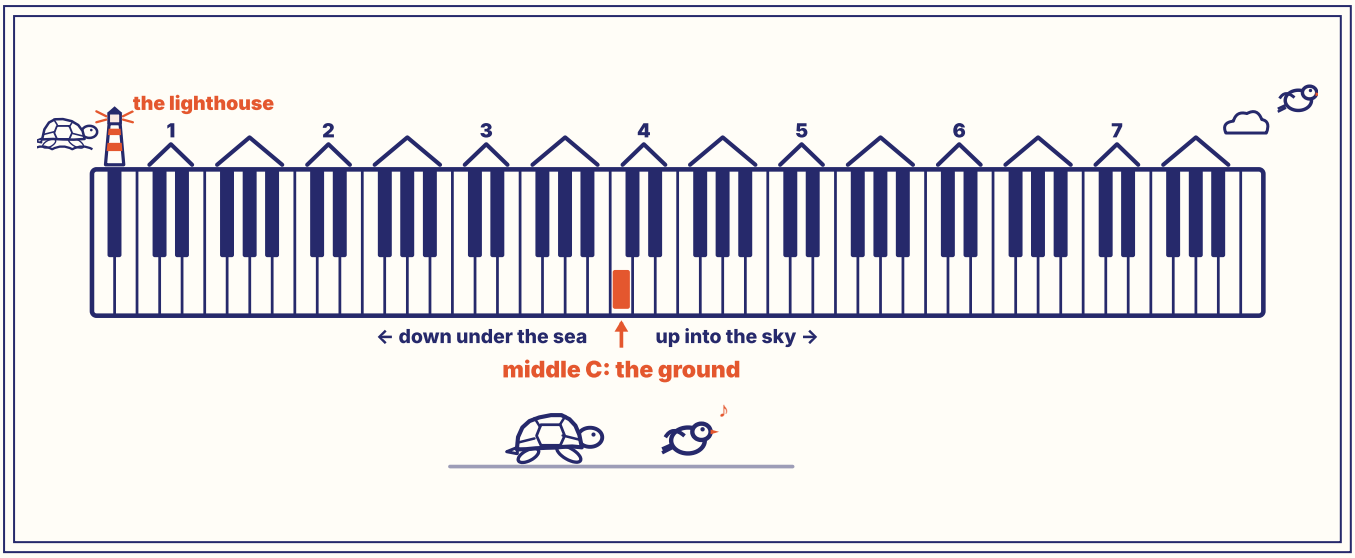
3 Eyes closed: someone plays one high or one low note. Point to the end it came from. ☐

REMEMBER **Two black keys: the small house. Three: the big house. Low on the left, high on the right.**

STEP 3

The whole piano & middle C

A real piano has 88 keys: **7 groups of 2** and 7 groups of 3, plus a few keys at each end (page 1's answer: 7). Count to the 4th group of 2: the white key just left of it is **middle C**, the centre of the piano.



At the piano

1 Count the groups of 2 from the bottom: 1 up to 7, touching each one. ☐

2 Find the single black key at the very bottom, and the lowest white key beside it. ☐

3 Play middle C, then the C one group lower and one group higher. ☐

REMEMBER **Middle C: the left of the 4th group of 2. Up is higher, down is lower.**

CHECK-UP

Chapter 2 check

Show each one at the piano and tick it: not yet, nearly, or yes.

		NOT YET	NEARLY	YES
1	I can find a group of 2 and a group of 3 anywhere	○	○	○
2	I can hear high and low and point to each end	○	○	○
3	I can say how many white keys each group has: 3 and 4	○	○	○
4	I can find middle C	○	○	○
5	I can play legato with 2 3 4 on a group of 3	○	○	○

Next, chapter 3: every white key gets its name.